

# Pre-class setup checklist

n8n basics + Telegram AI bot · Total time: 15–20 minutes

## Before the class

You are about to build a working AI Telegram bot on n8n Cloud. The class moves quickly, so we want everyone arriving with accounts already created and the Telegram app installed. This avoids the first part of the session being lost to signups.

**What you will do today.** Four short tasks, in order. Each one has a time estimate and a why. If a task is blocked, skip it and message the facilitator — do not let one item stop you from finishing the rest.

## Required setup

**1**

### Install Telegram on your phone 5 min

*Why:* You will message your bot from this app — and create the bot itself through it.

- [ ] Open the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android) and install **Telegram Messenger**.
- [ ] Open the app and complete signup with your phone number — Telegram sends a verification code.
- [ ] Set a username under *Settings* → *Username* so people can find you without your phone number.

**2**

### Create your bot with BotFather 5 min

*Why:* Every Telegram bot is registered through BotFather. You will paste its token into n8n.

- [ ] In Telegram search, type **@BotFather**. Tap the result with the **blue verified tick** (avoid imposters).
- [ ] Send the message **/newbot**.
- [ ] When asked for a display name, type something like *My AI helper*.
- [ ] When asked for a username, type something ending in **bot** — e.g. *swarup\_ai\_helper\_bot*. It must be unique across all of Telegram.
- [ ] BotFather replies with a token like `1234567890:ABC...xyz` — copy it into a private note. Treat it like a password.

**3****Create an n8n Cloud account** 5 min

*Why:* This is the workspace where you will build the bot workflow. 14-day free trial — no card needed.

- [ ] Visit **app.n8n.cloud** in your browser.
- [ ] Sign up with your email (or Google / GitHub). Verify the email.
- [ ] Pick a short workspace subdomain when prompted — e.g. *yourname.app.n8n.cloud*.
- [ ] Land on the workflows dashboard. You do not need to create a workflow yet — just confirm you can sign in.

**4****Have your Gemini API key ready** 2 min

*Why:* The bot needs an LLM "brain". We will paste this key into n8n live in class.

- [ ] Locate your existing **Google Gemini API key**.
- [ ] Paste it into a private note alongside your BotFather token so both are ready when class starts.
- [ ] You do not need to add it to n8n yet — we do that together in class.

## Before you log off — quick check

**Confirm all four before class:**

- [ ] Telegram app installed and signed in
- [ ] BotFather token saved somewhere safe
- [ ] n8n Cloud signed up — you can reach your dashboard
- [ ] Gemini API key on hand

## If something blocks you

**BotFather isn't responding.** Make sure you tapped the verified account with the blue tick — there are imposters with similar names.

**n8n verification email never arrives.** Check spam. If still nothing in 10 minutes, use Google or GitHub OAuth signup instead.

**You can't find your Gemini API key.** Sign in to Google AI Studio, open the API keys section, and either copy an existing key or create a new one.

**Still stuck.** Message the facilitator *before* class — most issues take 2–3 minutes to fix once we know.